

Tips on how to make great beer!

**RECOMMENDATION:
READ THESE TIPS FROM BEGINNING TO END BEFORE YOU BEGIN.**

Water Tips

Beer is mostly water, as you probably know from all the large breweries' advertisements on TV. The water you use for your beer should be the best you can get. Tap water is OK if its clean and clear, tastes good and doesn't smell like chlorine (or anything else for that matter). If you have a water filter use it! If you don't have good, clean tasting, smell free tap water or a filter buy 5 gallons of spring or drinking water from the store... you will be happy you did!

Brewing Tips

When stirring your Beer Man beer kit and water in the fermenter with your brewing paddle, you may think it will never all dissolve. Keep going, it will dissolve, however leaving small amounts of undissolved malt will not hurt. The yeast will find it and eat it without problems.

So you want beer with more kick (AKA alcohol) what do you add? First I have to say this. Plain old table sugar is NOT an ingredient in beer. When you go out and order a beer you don't get beer with sugar in it. That's because beer is made of 4 things in this order, Water, Malt, Hops and Yeast. Note, no sugar is listed! However this is your beer and you can add what you want to add. First you can add more malt. Add a pound of dry malt extract. Honey: add a pound or two of honey. Brown sugar: add a pound if you like. Fruit juice in place of brewing water will work well as long as it doesn't have ANY potassium sorbate in it. Get PASTEURIZED JUICE ONLY! Say something like a raspberry Pilsner. Add about a gallon or two in place of brewing water

Bottling Tips

The first 1/2-cup of beer that comes out of your bottle filler when you start filling your first bottle will be very cloudy from yeast settling into the spigot. Just dump the first 1/2-cup of cloudy beer out of the first bottle into the sink and keep going. It will not hurt a thing.

Sanitizing bottles can be fun. Squeeze the bottles to suck sanitizer into the bottle and then shake a few times and then squeeze to expel the sanitizer. You only need to get the inside wet to be effective with our no rinse sanitizer.

Keeep your bottles clean. After you drain a bottle of beer, rinse it out a few times to make sure all the yeast in the bottom is out. The yeast in the Beer Man Microbrewery will stick to the bottom of the bottle so shake hard to dislodge it.

The bottling wand will drip. Place a small bowl under it to keep the floor clean and make clean up a snap

When filling your bottles, fill then to the top or as close as you can get to the top, WHEN THE BOTTLE FILLER IS STILL IN THE BOTTLE. What this does is this. There needs to be a small amount of space in each bottle for the yeast to carbonate the beer in the bottle. The bottle filler takes up space when in the bottle and when you remove the bottle from the filler the level of beer in the bottle drops to the perfect level for the perfect amount of carbonation to form. It's easy!

Aging Tips

You can certainly drink your beer as soon as its carbonated and cold BUT aging it a week or more will greatly improve its flavor and make it much smoother. You will notice that the last beer of a batch is the best due to it aging the longest.

I like to surprise my friends with my home brewed beer. When you offer a beer to your buddies that don't know you have a Beer Man Microbrewery don't tell them up front you made it. Lets face it, home brewed beer can have a bad reputation thanks to prohibition brewers (AKA bathtub beer). Just pour a cold clear beer into a nice clean glass and give it to them. Then wait for them to ask for more. You will be surprised at how much they will like it.

www.beermanmicrobrewery.com